Add Meta WhatsApp test recipients

Manual setup guide for DentaFlow / N.I SMILE | 2026-10-17

Why this is manual

Meta does not provide a public Graph API to add numbers to the WhatsApp Cloud API test allowlist. Recipients must be added and verified in Meta Developers. This guide walks through that console flow.

1 Open your Meta app

developers.facebook.com

- Sign in at https://developers.facebook.com/
- Open the App used for N.I SMILE / DentaFlow WhatsApp.
- In the left menu, open WhatsApp -> API Setup (sometimes shown as WhatsApp -> Configuration).

2 Confirm the test From number

Step 1 - Select phone numbers

- Under Send and receive messages, find From.
- Keep Meta's provided test phone number selected while you are still testing.
- Do not switch to a production business number until Edge secrets (WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID / token) are updated for production.

3 Open the recipient list

To -> Manage phone number list

- In the same section, open the To dropdown.
- Choose Manage phone number list (or Manage Phone Number List).
- Click Add phone number / Add Test Number.

4 Add and verify each recipient

Up to 5 numbers on the Meta test number

- Enter country code and a valid WhatsApp mobile number (example: +252 63 ...).
- Click Next / Continue.
- Meta sends a verification code in WhatsApp to that handset. Open WhatsApp on the phone, read the code, and type it into Meta to confirm.
- Repeat for each tester (owner phone, clinic phone, etc.), up to five total.

Important limits

Once a recipient is added to Meta's test list, it usually cannot be removed. Choose numbers carefully. This limit applies only to Meta's free test From number. Your own registered production WhatsApp Business number has no recipient allowlist.

5 Send a Meta console test (optional)

hello_world template

- Back on API Setup, keep From = test number and To = your verified recipient.
- Use Send message with the pre-approved hello_world template.
- Confirm the WhatsApp arrives on the handset.

6 Use the same numbers in DentaFlow

Cloud API send from /whatsapp

- In DentaFlow, queue messages only to phones that are already verified on Meta's list while you are still on the test From number.
- On /whatsapp, use Process due / Send via Meta. Edge secrets must already include WHATSAPP_ACCESS_TOKEN and WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID for the test number.
- When go-live is ready: register the clinic's dedicated WhatsApp production number on Meta, update Edge secrets to that phone number id, then you can message any opted-in customer without this allowlist step.

7 Quick checklist

- [ ] Meta Developers app opened
- [ ] WhatsApp -> API Setup
- [ ] From = Meta test number
- [ ] To -> Manage phone number list
- [ ] Recipient added with country code
- [ ] Verification code entered from WhatsApp
- [ ] hello_world test received (optional)
- [ ] DentaFlow queue send tested to that phone

Prepared by M2B Technology Innovation Solutions for N.I SMILE Oral care & Teeth whitening (DentaFlow). UI labels in Meta may change slightly; look for API Setup, From/To, and Manage phone number list.